

# CHIRAYU KAINYA

Product Manager | AI-Native Business Leader | Data-Driven Retail Strategist

+91-9029304085 | chirayu.v.kainya@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/chirayukainya | Mumbai, India

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## S U M M A R Y

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Business leader with 8.5 years across data science, analytics, product management, and program leadership in retail, e-commerce, and supply chain. Led digital transformation of physical retail operations — from manual visual merchandising (VM) to AI-driven automation across 2,000+ stores. Built products from zero to scale across 4 retail formats. Designed data pipelines handling 250 GB daily, AI systems automating entire PM lifecycles, and VM platforms that reduced manual effort by 80%+. Deep domain expertise spanning merchandising, customer experience, store operations, and warehouse optimization — from inventory recovery worth hundreds of crores (~\$25M+) to reducing shrinkage and streamlining fulfillment. AI-native operator who treats AI as the default operating layer, not an occasional tool.

## E X P E R I E N C E

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### Product Manager

Fynd (Reliance Industries Ltd.) • Mumbai • October 2023 – Present

#### Store to Shelf — Visual Merchandising & Space Planning (2025–2026)

- **Co-created Visual Merchandising (VM) and Space Planning products** with GMetri (external vendor) from scratch — both capabilities didn't exist. Extended across 4 retail formats: Trends (1,600 stores, 5 automated product placement strategies), Hamleys (toy retail — eye-level & age-group based merchandising), F&L (automated daily color stories, brand-specific placement rules), and Dark Store Grocery (bin allocation, order picking optimization).
- **Achieved 80%+ reduction in VM manual work** through automated guidelines, best-seller reporting, automated PDF reports, and intelligent product placement algorithms.
- **Onboarded ~2,000 Trends stores in 2 months**; established batch processing (100 stores/batch), 150 stores/day validation, 30 stores/day CAD-to-3D pipeline verification.
- **Built image pipeline** tracking 51,000+ style-color IDs across 122,000+ stock option codes with a 5-source priority chain; achieved 92% data accuracy validated against ground truth.
- **Built Digital Twin of retail stores** — integrating real-time data, operational processes, and 3D visualization into a single platform. Replaced manual VM, paper-based compliance, and in-person audits with automated planograms, RFID-enabled fixture-to-product level compliance tracking, fixture serialization (unique IDs across all stores), and a 3-tier layout approval workflow (store proposes, area manager reviews, HQ approves). Shifted RFID tagging from stores to distribution centers, increasing processing speed from 1 piece/min to 30 pieces/min.
- **Built 22-skill AI-powered PM system** using Claude Code — automating sprint planning (1 hr to 15 min), Jira backlog management, 8-dimension risk detection, vendor SLA tracking, and Slack notifications. Self-initiated.
- **Automated store audits using computer vision** — built system that compares fixture photos against planogram suggestions to flag deviations, replacing manual area-manager visits. Combined with RFID for complete fixture-to-product compliance tracking without human intervention.
- **Built Agentic Space Planning system** — AI agent that ingests sales data, stock levels, and category performance, then autonomously runs competitor analysis (Google-based market scanning) to recommend store layout changes aimed at improving visibility, conversion, and revenue per square foot.

#### Impetus Platform — Integrations & Store Operations (2024–2025)

- **Built 250 GB daily data pipeline** (Increff to RRA to Centric) in 2 days; implemented alert systems for missing files, extended to Manthan, proving superior to existing SFTP-based transfers.
- **Reduced planogram creation time** from 3 hours to 15 minutes per store using Quant Dynamic Planograms — first store-specific dynamic planograms in Fashion & Lifestyle across the ecosystem.
- **Digitized support operations end-to-end** — replaced email/call-based support with a structured ticketing platform scaled from 3–4 tickets/week to 300 tickets/day; deployed AI Co-Pilot chatbot reducing resolution time from 7 days to 3 days; cut support costs 80% by migrating Freshdesk to Jira.
- **Completed master data synchronization** across Impetus platform in 2 days — correcting SAP discrepancies across article hierarchy, color, pattern, size configurations.

- **Led customer analytics initiative** using CCTV-based insights with Resolute AI — tracking dwell time, zone-level engagement, and customer movement patterns to inform VM and store layout decisions. Collaborated with Neophyte and JioACS for in-store behavior analytics.
- **Led hiring drive** for Business Process Managers and Data Analysts; trained and onboarded 900+ users (vendors, store ops, buyers, designers) on new platforms.

## Technical Program Manager

**Fynd (Reliance Industries Ltd.) — Advanced Commerce Lab** • Mumbai • January 2023 – September 2023

- **Address Engine:** built end-to-end address tokenization pipeline using Google Places API + fuzzy logic + lat-long generation. Reduced Return to Origin (RTO) by 25%. Identified unique market features (residential/commercial flags, fraud-prone location detection). Appreciated by leadership.
- **Demand Forecasting:** developed 90%+ accuracy time-series forecasting model for Netmeds using Vertex AI Auto ML. Conducted PoC with Mufti leading to 2% margin increase through price adjustments.
- **Retail Assortment Engine:** collaborated with Chief Operations Controller at Reliance Retail to automate optimal SKU (Stock Keeping Unit) quantity calculations; identified top 20% articles driving 80% of revenue.
- **Implemented Dataform** for data versioning, lineage, and cataloguing in BigQuery — open-source solution reducing query execution and storage costs by 30%+.

## Data Analyst

**Fynd (Reliance Industries Ltd.) — JioMart** • Mumbai • December 2021 – December 2022

- **Built BAD (Become a Debugger) tool:** Python-based multi-DB debugging utility saving 15 min/case for Product Support Engineers (PSE). Extended with Data Studio UI reducing request resolution time to 3 seconds.
- **Created POSDM utility** for RIL Finance — automated reversal of 15K financial entries (3-month task completed in 3 days at 10 entries/minute).
- **Built smart Python scheduler** replacing cron tab access limitations; automated report pipelines saving 2+ hrs/day/person.
- **Created consolidated dashboards** tracking leakage metrics and business KPIs at customer and category level; used by leadership team for business decisions.
- **Increased team productivity 1.5x** through automation; saved 3–4 hours per Product Support Engineer per day.

## Assistant Manager — Analytics

**Flipkart (Internal move from Myntra)** • Bangalore • April 2021 – December 2021

- Analyzed excess shipment patterns driven by inventory mirroring and operational issues; developed tool measuring impact of portal offers on shipment volume, revenue growth, and customer engagement.
- Worked on basket size optimization — analyzing units per shipment (U2S), shipment building logic, and cross-docking strategies to improve items per order.

## Data Analyst

**Myntra Designs Pvt. Ltd. (Flipkart Group)** • Bangalore • July 2019 – April 2021

- **Orphan Inventory Resolution:** developed Python tool matching untagged products via brand-winter-color-size attributes; made 20 lakh (~2 million) orphan items live, recovering inventory worth several hundred crores (~\$25M+).
- **Reduced high-value item pilferage by 4%** within 3 months through EDA-driven tamper-proof packaging and covered lid transfer processes.
- **Reduced bad quality inventory by 40%** through automated product assessment tool (Return to Vendor, Liquidation, Refinishing).
- **Built financial reports** and automated reporting; stakeholders included Legal, Finance, Warehouse Operations, and Data teams.

## Associate Analyst — Data Science

**Infosys** • Bangalore • November 2017 – July 2019

- **UPS:** built driver churn prediction model and bid optimization engine using ML classification algorithms.
- **Starbucks:** developed reporting automation via Excel and R.
- **Route Optimization:** implemented Clark-Wright parallel routing algorithm and genetic algorithms; used Random Forest for bid win/loss classification.
- Conducted sales anomaly detection using R, web scraping, and social media analytics.

## IMPACT AT A GLANCE

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- **1,600+ stores** adopted VM automation with 75% satisfactory output across 4 retail formats
- **~2,000 stores** onboarded in 2 months with batch processing and daily validation workflows
- **92% data accuracy** validated against ground truth (cross-system normalization across incompatible formats)
- **80%+ reduction** in VM manual work through automated guidelines, reporting, and product placement algorithms
- **250 GB daily pipeline** built in 2 days; backbone for all critical retail integrations
- **Planogram creation:** 3 hours reduced to 15 minutes per store
- **Support platform:** scaled from 3 tickets/week to 300 tickets/day; resolution time 7 days to 3 days
- **Sprint planning:** 1 hour reduced to 15 minutes via 22-skill AI PM system
- **20 lakh (~2M) orphan items** recovered at Myntra, worth ~\$25M+
- **4 retail formats** scaled: Trends, Hamleys, F&L, Dark Store Grocery

## SKILLS

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**Strategy & Leadership:** Product Vision & Roadmaps, Strategic Prioritization, Vendor Co-creation, Stakeholder Management, Cross-functional Program Management, Agile/Scrum, Sprint Planning, Backlog Management, Change Management, KPI Tracking, Revenue Growth Strategy

**Data & AI:** Python, SQL, BigQuery, PostgreSQL, GCS, Pandas, Scikit-Learn, XGBoost, LLMs (BERT, CRF, GPT), Claude Code, MCP Integration, Computer Vision, API Integration, Jira API Orchestration, Kafka, Dataform, Streamlit

**Retail & Operations:** Visual Merchandising, Space Planning, Planogram Design (Quant, GMetri), RFID, Digital Twin, Store Operations, Warehouse Management, Inventory Optimization, OTB/AOP Planning, PLM (Product Lifecycle Management), Category Management, Supply Chain Planning

**Platforms & Tools:** GCP, AWS, Jira, Confluence, Freshdesk, Centric PLM, Increff, SAP, Quant Retail, GMetri, Anytrac, PulsePoint, Looker Studio, Geckoboard, Postman, Git

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Agile Coach Certification (ICP-ACC)
- Data Analyst Nanodegree – Udacity
- Full Stack Web Developer Nanodegree – Udacity
- Predictive Analytics with Power BI Nanodegree – Udacity
- Oracle Certified Programmer – Java 6
- Retail Planning (OTB/AOP) – Udemy
- Data Privacy Certification
- Multiple courses: Product Management, Supply Chain Planning (Coursera, LinkedIn Learning)

## AWARDS & RECOGNITION

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- Store to Shelf platform designated "Phase 0" by Reliance senior leadership for INR 100 Cr/day (~\$12M/day) revenue target (2026)
- Annual Award for Complete Ownership – Fynd (2023)
- Fynd Stars Award (2023)
- Top 8 – Crackathon (Generative AI) — NLP-to-SQL query solution (2023)
- "Make It Happen – Individual Contributor" Award – Myntra (2020–21)
- Appreciation from Reliance business leaders for single-handedly implementing Quant across stores

## EDUCATION

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**Bachelor of Engineering (Information Technology)**

University of Mumbai • 2017 • CGPA: 7.87

- Published: "A Comparative Study of Various Data Mining Algorithms for Employability Prediction"